Bull Exerciser



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Bull exerciser

What it is used for

A bull exerciser is used to provide controlled physical activity for breeding bulls under a planned animal-management routine. Correct setup, close supervision, and careful handling help maintain animal fitness while reducing stress and injury risks.

Main parts

- Exercise frame or walking area provides the designated movement space.
- Drive mechanism moves the exercise equipment where fitted.
- Control panel or switch operates the powered system where fitted.
- Speed or movement control adjusts the exercise rate where provided.
- Barriers and gates help manage animal movement.
- Restraint or guiding equipment supports controlled handling where approved.
- Emergency stop halts powered movement where fitted.
- Inspection and maintenance points allow routine equipment checks.

Before you start

1. Only trained animal handlers should operate the bull exerciser.
2. Check the bull's health, temperament, and suitability for exercise with the responsible veterinarian or animal-care professional where needed.
3. Inspect the frame, floor, barriers, gates, drive mechanism, and controls for damage.
4. Confirm that the exercise area is dry, non-slip, free of obstacles, and adequately ventilated.
5. Check that emergency stops and protective guards work correctly on powered models.
6. Prepare suitable assistance and follow the facility's animal-handling and exercise plan.

How to use

1. Guide the bull calmly into the designated exercise area using the approved handling method.
2. Secure gates and barriers according to the equipment instructions without causing distress.
3. Start the exercise system at the prescribed low setting where speed control is available.
4. Observe the bull continuously and allow movement at the rate specified by the animal-care plan.
5. Check for signs of fatigue, lameness, overheating, distress, or abnormal behaviour.
6. Stop the system immediately if the bull becomes distressed, loses balance, or enters an unsafe position.
7. Finish the session according to the planned duration and stop all powered movement before releasing the animal.
8. Guide the bull out through the designated route and check its condition after exercise.

9. Record exercise duration, observations, equipment faults, and any required follow-up.

⚠ Safety

- Never leave a bull unattended during exercise.
- Keep handlers and bystanders outside crush, kick, and entanglement zones.
- Do not use the exerciser on an injured, ill, overheated, or unsuitable animal without veterinary clearance.
- Never force a bull to continue when it shows distress, fatigue, or loss of coordination.
- Keep hands and clothing away from moving parts and use the emergency stop when necessary.
- Do not modify the equipment or use restraints contrary to the approved procedure.

Care & storage

- Remove manure, mud, and debris from the exercise area after use.
- Inspect barriers, gates, flooring, drive components, and controls regularly.
- Clean and disinfect equipment using animal-safe products where required.
- Report unusual noise, damaged parts, or unreliable controls and arrange authorised repairs.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Starting exercise without checking the bull's health and temperament.
- Using a slippery or obstructed exercise area.
- Leaving the bull unsupervised or ignoring signs of fatigue.
- Releasing the bull before all powered movement has stopped.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.